we visited him at his place of business on September 1. That was the sort of job he had before his ill-starred venture into entre-preneurship, and words cannot describe how relieved I was that he was back where he belonged.

I got a new typewriter at last while in New York. It was another Smith-Corona portable and replaced the old one that my father had gotten for me twelve years before. I carefully kept the old one as a fallback, however, following my usual procedure of keeping all my options open.

On September 3, I drove to Newark, where I gave a talk at Sam Moskowitz's science-fiction group there. After dinner, I drove back to Brooklyn at night. It was the first night driving I had done and, as I said in my diary, "Snow and ice are all I have not yet experienced." But then, I was in no hurry for those.

On September 5, 1950 (my mother's fifty-fifth birthday), I drove

6 See Buy Jupiter and Other Stories (Doubleday, 1973).

7 See Buy Jupiter and Other Stories.

Gertrude and myself back to Boston. It took me only six hours that time, and at one point I actually hit a speed of eighty miles an hour.

By September 8, I had a note from Brad to the effect that the new chapters were very good, that I was constantly improving, and that Doubleday wanted to stick with me.

Good! For I wanted to stick with them!

I finally finished the last word of The Stars like Dust— on September 17 and mailed it off on the eighteenth. It had been much harder to write than Pebble in the Sky but it was done and "in press," as I now learned to say.

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Meanwhile, a new and completely different project had been begun, quite unexpectedly.

Ever since Bill had come back from Egypt he had been aching for some project he could throw himself into that would wipe out, in his own mind, the fiasco of the Egyptian venture. He had done a very highy regarded text in immunochemistry and had revised it into an equally good new edition. Now it occurred to him to do a general text of biochemistry for medical students. On